Jeffrey A. Levy

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Updated: October 25, 2026

Nationality: USA

CURRENT AFFILIATION

Michigan State University, Department of Economics
Assistant Professor of Instruction — August 2026 - Present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, American University — December 2020
Dissertation: *"Essays on Uncertainty and Macroeconomic Dynamics"*
Committee: Xuguang Sheng (chair), Gabriel Mathy, Scott Baker, Svetlana Makarova (external reader)

M.S. in Economics, American University — August 2014

B.A. in Economics & Political Science, Michigan State University — May 2010

FIELDS AND INTERESTS

- Applied economics
- Macroeconomics
- Data science
- Pedagogy
- Open source programming

PAST AFFILIATIONS

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy
Assistant Instructional Professor — April 2019 - August 2026

Urban Institute, *Washington, DC*
Data Scientist — June 2016 - April 2019

American University, *Washington, DC*
Adjunct Faculty — Fall 2016
Teaching Assistant — 2012 - 2016
Research Assistant — 2013, 2014, 2016

Brookings Institution, *Washington, DC*
Research Assistant — Fall 2013

PUBLICATIONS

Baker, Scott R., Steven J. Davis, and Jeffrey A. Levy. "State-level economic policy uncertainty." *Journal of Monetary Economics* 132 (2022): 81-99

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Separating uncertainty from first-moment shocks: Evidence from BRAC" with Xuguang Sheng and Gabriel Mathy, in revision 2026

"Machine-Made Signals: Generative AI, Student Code, and Early Career Outcomes" with Christopher Clapp and Michael O'Neil, pending 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Michigan State University, Department of Economics

EC 202: Introduction to Macroeconoimics
Self-designed undergradate level (5 sections) 2026 - 2027

EC 201: Introduction to Microeconoimics
Self-designed undergraduate level (1 section) 2026

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

PPHA 30537: Data and Programming for Public Policy I: Python
Self-designed 1st year MPP level (19 sections) 2019 - 2026

PPHA 30545: Machine Learning for Public Policy
Department course 2nd year MPP level (6 sections) 2025

Math and Coding Camp: Accelerated R
Incoming graduate students (4 sections) 2024 - 2025

Data and Policy Summer Scholar Program
Professional course using R for non-degree students 2024

PPHA 30538: Data and Programming for Public Policy II: Python
Self-designed 2nd year MPP level (10 sections) 2019 - 2023

PPHA 30536: Data and Programming for Public Policy II: R
Self-designed 2nd year MPP level (4 sections) 2021 - 2022

PPHA 23400: Principles of Microeconomics and Public Policy II
Department course 1st year MPP level (4 sections) 2019 - 2020

Harris School of Public Policy, Graduate Development Program

DSC Data Management Track: Capstone Project
Self-designed non-degree program, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia 2023 - 2024

DSC Data Management Track: Advanced Excel and PowerBI
Self-designed non-degree program, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia 2024

DSC Data Management Track: MatLab Applications
Self-designed non-degree program, remote 2023

Urban Institute

Python for Data Science
Self-designed professional training, Washington DC 2017

American University

ECON 200: Principles of Microeconomics
Department course 1st year undergrad level 2016

PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

University of Illinois February 27th, 2026
"Machine Learning for Social and Behavioral Science Workshop II" Champaign, IL

University of Illinois October 3rd, 2025
"Machine Learning for Social and Behavioral Science Workshop" Champaign, IL

Stanford SITE Conference September 8th, 2023

"The causal impact of uncertainty shocks" Stanford, CA

Urban Institute Webinar October 17, 2017
"Apache Spark for Social Science" Washington, DC.

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting November 20, 2016
"Measuring Economic Uncertainty in US States" Washington, DC

Urban Institute Series October 25, 2016
"Python for Researchers" Washington, DC

Center for Advanced Modeling at Johns Hopkins University July 10, 2014
"Contract Enforcement and Group Formation: An Agent Based Model of the Maghribi Traders" Baltimore, MD

SERVICE TO DEPARTMENT

Advising: Michigan State Economics Club (2026-current)
Organized panels: 2021-2025 From New Grad to Analyst: Making the Transition
Organized workshops: Code Sample Workshop: MatLab (2024)
Supervised independent study: Autumn 2023, Spring 2023 (2x), Spring 2021

SERVICE TO PROFESSION

Referee: Review of Economics and Statistics, Economics and Business Letters, International Journal of Forecasting, Quantitative Economics
Member: American Economic Association, Midwest Economic Association, Python Software Foundation

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

CTL Pedagogy Fellow 2023-2024
UChicago Center for Teaching and Learning

Outstanding Lecturer of the Year 2021
Nomination, Harris School student body

President's Award for Technology Innovation in Research 2016
Urban Institute

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

- Python
- R
- Stata
- MATLAB
- SQL
- Apache Spark
- PowerBI